University of Jena
Department of English and American Studies
Summer 2019

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Cognitive English Grammar

BA.AA.SW05
Monday, 4 - 6 pm
Carl-Zeiß-Straße 3, SR 124
5 ECTS

(Sunset at a flooded rice field, by Simon Wong)

Seminar Description

> In elementary school, I was taught that a noun is the name of a person, place, or thing. In college, I was taught the basic linguistic doctrine that a noun can only be defined in terms of grammatical behavior, conceptual definitions of grammatical classes being impossible. Here, several decades later, I demonstrate the inexorable progress of grammatical theory by claiming that a noun is the name of a thing.
>
> (Langacker, 2008, p. 93)

The study of grammar is essential to the study of language, yet, often considered artificial, formalistic, and out of touch with the reality of language use and learning. In this seminar, students will be introduced to what is known as Cognitive Grammar (Langacker, 1987, 1991). Proponents of Cognitive Grammar assume that grammar is meaningful: Like words, grammatical constructions associate form with meaning. Grammar is seen as a by-product of mental processses and is shaped by experiences of language use. In the course of the semester, students will learn to define and explain basic concepts of Cognitive Grammar and to describe aspects of the English grammar in a meaningful and usage-based way. They will learn to analyze samples of language in Cognitive Grammar categories and determine the underlying mental processes. They will describe and discuss ways to apply Cognitive Grammar to second language teaching. Moreover, they will learn to read and present empirical papers. The seminar and all readings are in English.

Addressees

This seminar is aimed at B.A. and teacher students of English who have completed the module Introduction to Linguistics and M.A. students of economic education ("Wirtschaftspädagogik").

Date	Topic	Basic reading	Empirical reading
04-08-2019	Introduction and basic assumptions of CL	—	—
04-15-2019	Cognitive operations in thought and language	Radden and Dirven (2007, ch. 2)	—
04-22-2019	Official holiday	—	—
04-29-2019	How to read and present empirical research	Bourne (2007)	—
05-06-2019	Inofficial holiday	—	—
05-13-2019[a]	Types of things: Nouns	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 63–71)	Middleton et al. (2004)
05-20-2019[a]	Grounding things: Reference	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 87–91, 96–99)	Arnold and Griffin (2007)
05-27-2019	Quantifying things: Quantifiers	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 115–127)	Brooks and Braine (1996)
06-03-2019	Qualifying things: Modifiers	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 141–145, 161–166)	Fox and Thompson (1990)
06-10-2019	Cognitive Linguistics and SL instruction	Bielak and Pawlak (2013, ch. 4.2, 4.4)	—
06-17-2019	Aspect and tense	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 175–179, 201–208)	Niemeier and Reif (2008)
06-24-2019	Modality	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 233–239)	Tyler (2008)
07-01-2019	Event schemas: Sentence patterns	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 269–272)	Tyler (2012, ch. 6)
07-08-2019	Space and more: Complements and adjuncts	Radden and Dirven (2007, pp. 303–306)	Tyler (2012, ch. 5)

[a] With Barthe Bloom.

Requirements and grading system

Your grade will depend on a **seminar paper** (submission **deadlines September 27, 2019 and November 05, 2019**). You need to hand in both a paper copy and a digital copy. **Only the hand-signed paper copy counts!** Your paper needs to be between ten and 15 pages long and follow the guideline by Schmidtke-Bode (ms). To be admitted to the seminar paper, a visible commitment to the seminar (continual and active **participation**) is required. **You're allowed to miss class twice**. Moreover, weekly preparation in the form of readings and accompanying homework will be required (see **Weekly requirements**). In addition, you need to present an additional reading in class at least once.

Weekly requirements: Readings and questions

Each week, you need to read the listed **readings, both basic and empirical**. Moreover, you need to hand in a **written question about the empirical reading** on Wordwise (see **Wordwise**). Your question needs to be at least 100 words long. You need to hand in at least four questions. The questions are **due each week on Monday before class, 11:59 noon**.

One-time requirements: Presentation

You need to **present an empirical reading** in class at least once. Your presentation should be 20 minutes long and will be followed by 10 minutes of discussion and feedback. Follow the rules for good presentations outlined by Bourne (2007).

Wordwise

You find readings and materials on the online platform of our department, Wordwise. Important information on the organization of the course will also be distributed via Wordwise (to your email address). Please enroll in this seminar on Wordwise (the password was announced in class) and stay updated. You also need to hand in your weekly questions on Wordwise.

Requirements overview

Requirement	Due date	Where
Four preparatory questions	Monday before class, 11:59 noon	Wordwise
Presentation additional reading	_____	in class
Seminar paper, 1st attempt	September 27, 2019, 12 midnight	postbox (+ email)
Seminar paper, 2nd attempt	November 05, 2019, 12 midnight	postbox (+ email)

References

Arnold, J. E. & Griffin, Z. M. (2007). The effect of additional characters on choice of referring expression: Everyone counts. *Journal of memory and language*, *56*(4), 521–536. doi:10.1016/j.jml.2006.09.007

Bielak, J. & Pawlak, M. (2013). *Applying cognitive grammar in the foreign language classroom: Teaching english tense and aspect*. Berlin, Germany: Springer.

Bourne, P. E. (2007). Ten simple rules for making good oral presentations. *PLoS Computational Biology*, *3*(4), e77. doi:10.1371/journal.pcbi.0030077

Brooks, P. J. & Braine, M. D. (1996). What do children know about the universal quantifiers all and each? *Cognition*, *60*(3), 235–268. doi:10.1016/0010-0277(96)00712-3

Fox, B. A. & Thompson, S. A. (1990). A discourse explanation of the grammar of relative clauses in english conversation. *Language*, *66*(2), 297–316. doi:10.2307/414888

Langacker, R. W. (1987). *Foundations of cognitive grammar: Theoretical prerequisites*. Stanford University Press.

Langacker, R. W. (1991). *Foundations of cognitive grammar: Descriptive application*. Stanford University Press.

Langacker, R. W. (2008). *Cognitive grammar: A basic introduction*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Middleton, E. L., Wisniewski, E. J., Trindel, K. A., & Imai, M. (2004). Separating the chaff from the oats: Evidence for a conceptual distinction between count noun and mass noun aggregates. *Journal of Memory and Language*, *50*(4), 371–394. doi:10.1016/j.jml.2004.02.005

Niemeier, S. & Reif, M. (2008). Making progress simpler? applying cognitive grammar to tense-aspect teaching in the german EFL classroom. In *Cognitive approaches to pedagogical grammar: A volume in honour of rené dirven* (pp. 325–355). Berlin: De Gruyter. doi:10.1515/9783110205381.3.325

Radden, G. & Dirven, R. (2007). *Cognitive english grammar*. John Benjamins. doi:10.1075/clip.2

Schmidtke-Bode, K. (ms). *Practical guidelines for writing a paper in linguistics*. online, Jena.

Tyler, A. (2008). Cognitive linguistics and second language instruction. In P. Robinson & N. C. Ellis (Eds.), *Handbook of cognitive linguistics and second language acquisition* (pp. 456–488). New York, NY: Routledge.

Tyler, A. (2012). *Cognitive linguistics and second language learning: Theoretical basics and experimental evidence*. New York, NY: Routledge.

Note: I reserve the right to alter this syllabus (dates, readings, assignments, et. al.) during the semester when I deem it necessary.